Project Baseline

Metrics

Metric	Value	Status
Performance	**31 / 100**	Poor
Accessibility	**79 / 100**	Fair
Best Practices	**54 / 100**	Poor
SEO	**85 / 100**	Good
Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)	**3.6 s**	Needs Improvement
Interaction to Next Paint (INP)	**155 ms**	Good
Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS)	**0.03**	Good
Overall Assessment	**Failed**	❌
First Contentful Paint (FCP)	**1.6 s**	Good

Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)	**5.1 s**	Poor
Speed Index	**10.4 s**	Poor
Total Blocking Time (TBT)	**3,830 ms**	Poor
Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS)	**0.064**	Good

Networking Statistics

Hard Reload

Metric	Value
Requests	**736**
Data Transferred	**9.9 MB**
Total Resource Size	**36.6 MB**
Finish Time	**7.13 s**
DOMContentLoaded	**2.52 s**

Soft Reload

Metric	Value
Requests	**679**
Data Transferred	**1.0 MB**

Total Resource Size	**36.4 MB**
Finish Time	**6.60 s**
DOMContentLoaded	**2.97 s**
Load	**6.21 s**

Cache Savings

Hard Reload:

9.9 MB

Soft Reload:

1.0 MB

Data Saved:

8.9 MB

Reduction:

≈90%

Resource Breakdown

Resource	Transferred	Resource Size
JavaScript	89.1 kB	3.42 MB
Images	640 kB	21.9 MB
CSS	0 kB	2.13 MB

Corrective Findings

Finding 1 – Very Large Network Payload

User Impact

The homepage downloads a very large amount of content, including images, advertisements, videos, and third-party resources. This increases loading time, particularly for users on slower internet connections or mobile networks.

Metrics Affected

- Performance Score
- Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)
- First Contentful Paint (FCP)
- Speed Index

Most Likely Cause

The homepage contains approximately **36.6 MB** of resources, with images making up nearly **22 MB** of the total page size.

Likely Solution

Compress images further, lazy-load media below the fold, reduce unnecessary downloads during the initial page load, and remove unused assets where possible.

Finding 2 – Excessive JavaScript Blocking

User Impact

Although content appears on screen, the page remains busy processing JavaScript, making interactions feel delayed.

Metrics Affected

- Total Blocking Time (TBT)
- Performance Score

Most Likely Cause

More than **3.4 MB** of JavaScript is loaded for advertisements, analytics, comments, videos, and other interactive features, creating long tasks on the browser's main thread.

Likely Solution

Reduce unused JavaScript, split large bundles into smaller chunks, and defer non-essential scripts until after the main content has loaded.

Finding 3 – Extremely High Number of Network Requests

User Impact

The browser must establish and manage hundreds of individual requests before the page fully loads, increasing overall loading time and network overhead.

Metrics Affected

- Finish Time
- Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)
- Performance Score

Most Likely Cause

The homepage loads **736 requests**, including news articles, advertisements, analytics services, fonts, scripts, and multimedia content.

Likely Solution

Reduce unnecessary requests, combine smaller assets where practical, and lazy-load resources that are not immediately visible.

Finding 4 – Images Dominate the Download Size

User Impact

Large images consume most of the downloaded data, increasing loading time and bandwidth usage, particularly on mobile devices.

Metrics Affected

- Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)
- Speed Index
- Finish Time

Most Likely Cause

Images account for approximately **21.9 MB** of the **36.6 MB** total page resources.

Likely Solution

Resize oversized images, compress them further, and use responsive images in modern formats such as WebP or AVIF.

Finding 5 – Heavy Dependence on Third-Party Resources

User Impact

Performance depends on external advertising, analytics, and tracking services. If any of these services respond slowly, users experience longer loading times.

Metrics Affected

- Performance Score
- Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)
- Total Blocking Time (TBT)
- Speed Index

Most Likely Cause

The page loads numerous third-party advertising and analytics scripts during the initial page load.

Likely Solution

Delay loading non-essential third-party services until after the primary content is displayed and remove services that provide little value.

Good Findings

Effective HTTP Compression

The website reduces transferred data from **36.6 MB** of resources to **9.9 MB** during the initial load, achieving approximately **73% compression**. This significantly lowers bandwidth usage without affecting content quality.

Excellent Browser Caching

A normal page refresh transfers only **1.0 MB** compared with **9.9 MB** during the initial visit, reducing downloaded data by approximately **90%**. CSS is served entirely from cache, making repeat visits much more efficient.

Overall Conclusion

AP News demonstrates good caching and compression practices, which substantially reduce bandwidth usage for returning visitors. However, its homepage is extremely resource-intensive, containing hundreds of network requests, large images, numerous third-party services, and several megabytes of JavaScript. These factors contribute to a low Performance score of **31**, a **5.1-second Largest Contentful Paint**, and a **3,830 ms Total Blocking Time**. Improving image optimization, reducing JavaScript execution, minimizing third-party resources, and lowering the total number of requests would significantly improve loading speed and overall user experience.

Mobile Metrics

Metric	Value	Rating
Performance Score	**29 / 100**	🔴 Poor

Accessibility	**76 / 100**	🟠 Needs Improvement
Best Practices	**77 / 100**	🟠 Needs Improvement
SEO	**85 / 100**	🟡 Good
First Contentful Paint (FCP)	**6.9 s**	🔴 Poor
Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)	**40.0 s**	🔴 Poor
Total Blocking Time (TBT)	**1,540 ms**	🔴 Poor
Speed Index	**16.8 s**	🔴 Poor
Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS)	**0.027**	🟢 Good

Finding 1 – Extremely Slow Largest Contentful Paint

Mobile users wait a very long time before the main content of the page becomes visible. Many users may leave the page before the largest image or article is fully loaded, especially on slower mobile networks.

Metrics Affected

- Largest Contentful Paint (40.0 s)
- First Contentful Paint (6.9 s)
- Speed Index (16.8 s)
- Overall Performance Score (29)

Most Likely Cause

The report shows several render-blocking JavaScript and CSS files delaying the initial rendering of the page. It also identifies very large images that are not optimized for mobile devices, with an estimated image delivery saving of about **2 MB**.

Recommended Solution

Reduce render-blocking resources by deferring non-critical JavaScript and inlining critical CSS. Optimize and compress large images, serve responsive image sizes, and lazy-load images that are not immediately visible.

Finding 2 – Inefficient Caching and Heavy Third-Party Resources

Returning visitors download many resources again instead of using cached versions, resulting in slower page loads and unnecessary network usage on mobile devices.

Metrics Affected

- Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)
- First Contentful Paint (FCP)
- Overall Performance Score

Most Likely Cause

The report recommends using longer cache lifetimes, estimating potential savings of approximately **1,628 KiB**. Many third-party resources, including advertising, analytics, and tracking scripts, use relatively short cache lifetimes, causing them to be downloaded frequently.

Recommended Solution

Increase cache lifetimes for static resources where possible, reduce unnecessary third-party scripts, and load advertising and analytics asynchronously so they do not delay the main page content.